



TIPS & TRICKS



Secure your Linux server with auto logout

The *root* account is the most privileged account on a *nix system and has no security restrictions imposed upon it. This means the system assumes you know what you are doing, and will do exactly what you request it to do. Therefore it is easy, with just a mis-typed command, to wipe out crucial system files. When using this account, it is important to be as careful as possible. For security reasons, it is recommended not to log in on your server as the *root* unless it is absolutely necessary. Now, let us look at how to set the login time out for the *root* account.

We often log in to the terminal as the *root* and leave it unattended or forget to log out after finishing our work, often leaving the terminal unattended.

Here is a tip that will solve this problem by automatically logging you out after a specified period of time. To do that, you must set the special variable *TMOUT*.

Edit the profile file and add the following line somewhere:

```
vi /etc/profile
```

```
TMOUT=7200
```

The value we enter for the variable '*TMOUT*=' is in seconds and represents two hours ($60 * 60 = 3600 * 2 = 7200$ seconds). It is important to note that if you decide to put the above line in your */etc/profile* file, then the automatic logout after two hours of inactivity will apply for all users on the system. So, instead, you may prefer to control which users will be automatically logged out and which ones will not. You can set this variable in their individual *.bashrc* files.

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Display coloured man pages

To display colours in man pages, use an application called *most*. In Debian-based GNU/Linux, you can install this package by using the following command:

```
[bash]$ apt-get install most
```

For rpm-based Linux, use *Yum* command as follows:

```
[bash]$ yum -y install most
```

After that, set the *PAGER* variable:

```
[bash]$ export PAGER="most"
```

Now run the *man* command and you will see colours in the man pages:

```
[bash]$ man ls
```

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Browse a tarfile with VIM

You can browse a tarfile with *VIM*, without extracting it, as shown below:

```
$ ls
```

```
cbrowser-0.8.tar.gz
```

```
$ vim cbrowser-0.8.tar.gz
```

```
" tar.vim version v23b
```

```
" Browsing tarfile /home/PU/rahu1.bedarkar/cbrowser-0.8.tar.gz
```

```
" Select a file with cursor and press ENTER
```

```
cbrowser-0.8/  
cbrowser-0.8/cbrowser  
cbrowser-0.8/widget.tcl  
cbrowser-0.8/hierarchy.tcl  
cbrowser-0.8/calltree.tcl  
cbrowser-0.8/builder.tcl  
cbrowser-0.8/ftcllib.tcl  
cbrowser-0.8/README  
cbrowser-0.8/tclIndex
```